
UNIT-1: Introduction

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- Intra-personal, Inter-personal and Group Communication

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PRACTICAL LABORATORY

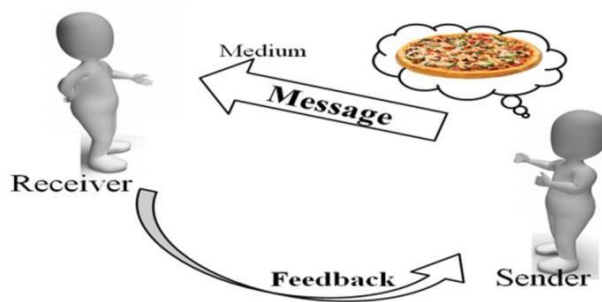
- Interactive Practical Lab on Oral Communication

UNIT-1

What is Communication?

Communication styles change from person to person. During the process of communication, a person may invoke several channels or modes or methods to convey a message. But, the process of communication doesn't only depend on the source producing or relaying information.

It also equally depends on the communication method and the manner in which the receiver understands the message. Let us first understand the method by which we communicate.



Communication begins at a given point. The first step is the generation of information. The second step is to put this information or data into a medium for transmission towards the intended audience.

Three Simple Definitions

- Communication means sharing of information
- Communication is the giving and receiving of messages
- Communication is the transfer of information from one or more people to one or more other people.

Definition of Communication:

Communication can broadly be defined as exchange of ideas, messages and information between two or more persons, through a medium, in a manner that the sender and the receiver understand the message, I.E., develop common understanding of the message.

The word communication is derived from the Latin word 'communicare', which means to share, impart, participate, exchange, transmit or to make common. It emphasizes on sharing common information, ideas and messages. It is not merely issuing orders and instructions.

“Communication is the transfer of information from a sender to a receiver, with the information being understood by the receiver”. — Koontz and Weihrich

“Communication is the art of developing and attaining understanding between people. It is the process of exchanging information and feelings

between two or more people and it is essential to effective management.”

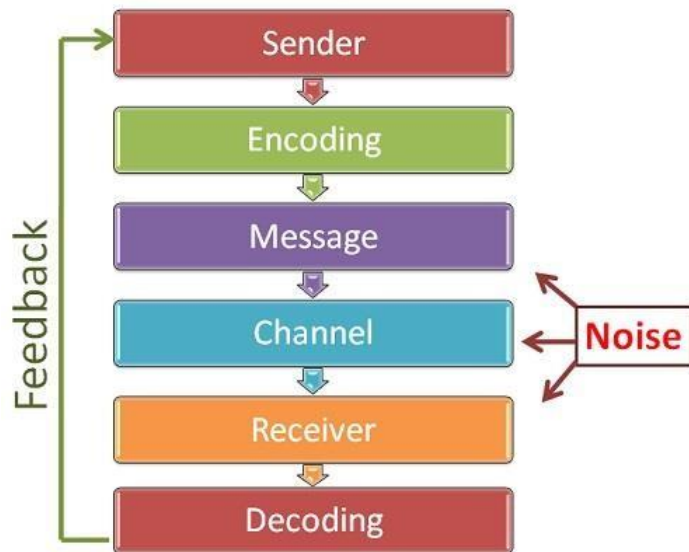
— Terry and Franklin

“Communication is the sum of all things one person does when he wants to create understanding in the mind of another. It is a bridge of meaning. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding.” — Allen Louis

“Communication is the process by which people attempt to share meaning via the transmission of symbolic messages.” — Stoner and Wankel

➤ **COMMUNICATIONS PROCESS**

Communications is a continuous process which mainly involves three elements viz. sender, message, and receiver. The elements involved in the communication process are:



1. **Sender:** The sender or the communicator generates the message and conveys it to the receiver. He is the source and the one who starts the communication.
2. **Message:** It is the idea, information, view, fact, feeling, etc. that is generated by the sender and is then intended to be communicated further.

- 3. Encoding:** The message generated by the sender is encoded symbolically such as in the form of words, pictures, gestures, etc. before it is being conveyed.
- 4. Media:** It is the manner in which the encoded message is transmitted. The message may be transmitted orally or in writing. The medium of communication includes telephone, internet, post, fax, e-mail, etc. The choice of medium is decided by the sender.
- 5. Noise:** It refers to any obstruction that is caused by the sender, message or receiver during the process of communication. For example, bad telephone connection, faulty encoding, faulty decoding, inattentive receiver, poor understanding of message due to prejudice or inappropriate gestures, etc.
- 6. Receiver:** He is the person who is last in the chain and for whom the message was sent by the sender. Once the receiver receives the message and understands it in proper perspective and acts according to the message, only then the purpose of communication is successful.
- 7. Decoding:** It is the process of converting the symbols encoded by the sender. After decoding the message is received by the receiver.
- 8. Feedback:** Once the receiver confirms to the sender that he has received the message and understood it, the process of communication is complete.

➤ The Broad Categories of Communication

Let us delve deep into the **5 types of communication** observed between the group of people or a formal team.

1) Verbal Communication - Verbal communication can also be called as Oral communication. In very simple terms, any communication that happens orally between people is known as verbal communication. The objective of such communications is to ensure that people understand whatever you want to convey. Because of its very nature, verbal communications is more quick and precise than email communication.

In the era of messaging via Whatsapp or using email, people still prefer personal meetings or phone calls (or face to face Skype calls) because they are effective and much more convenient in conveying the message.

Nowadays, Verbal communication is an important aspect and is looked as a key strength in an individual.

A manager or an executive needs to have good verbal communication skills. A manager has to handle a team of people and he needs to be skilled to convince the team of people in acting like he wants them to. Executives meet many customers who are each different in terms of their understanding and talking skills. Thus, Executives need excellent verbal communication skills.

The higher up an organization you go, the better should be the verbal skills that you have. This is because you need to ensure that your speech is

precise and to the point and does not leave any scope for any misunderstanding.

An M.D or a C.E.O may be giving a television interview which is being watched by 100's of stakeholders of the company. Their speech and verbal communication need to be precise so that they don't mess up or are not misunderstood. Even in tough times, the verbal communication skills of these leaders play a major part in consoling the crowd.

Example of people who were great at the verbal communication (Great ORATOR)

- Nelson Mandela
- Martin Luther King
- John F Kennedy
- Jawaharlal Nehru

2) Non-verbal / Interpersonal communication

How do you make people feel when you enter the room? Is your body language strong and are you standing straight and erect or are you slouched and tired? Are you clean shaven, looking your immaculate best for a team meeting or are you shabby with shirts that are not ironed? When you shake hands, do you do so strongly or do you just brush your hand against others?

The above were some examples of Non-verbal communications or interpersonal communications. One of the HR requirements for new joiners in an organization is for them to have good interpersonal skills. This basically means that the employees should brush up on their non-verbal skills.

If you were in a sales meeting and you have not achieved your target, how will you react? Will you be steady and calm or will you panic and stutter? These are important non-verbal skills and your growth might depend on them.

A manager who panics and who is not good at non-verbal communication will generally not be a favorite with his team members. This is because his team members do not look up to him. A manager who stutters, who is not well dressed, who has the wrong body language or someone who is not a strong personality, will not gather a huge following behind him.

However, people with good personalities go a long way in motivating the employees below them. If an employee is demotivated, just keeping a hand on their shoulder and saying a few motivating words is enough for the employee. Taunting them or making faces when talking to them, ignoring them completely or imitating them will demotivate the employee even further. Thus, non-verbal skills play a major role in office culture.

As employees grow into managers and as managers grow into leaders, they become better and better at a non-verbal type of communications. They know that their own calm headed behavior at times of panic is what will keep the team in check. Similarly, they don't let their teams get complacent when the going is good.

Example of the Non-verbal type of communications

In Customer service, non-verbal and interpersonal skills play a huge role. Imagine you were unhappy with a product and you went to the customer service department. Instead of understanding your problem, the customer service executive gives a rude reply. Repeatedly you visit them and even though the problem is not resolved, you don't get a satisfactory answer.

Compare that with a customer service department which smiles when you come in. They reassure you that they are on top of your problem. They are proactive and update you themselves on when to expect the problem to be resolved. Later on, they follow up whether you were satisfied with the response and if there was anything they could do further.

This smile, the body language of reassurance, the listening ability are all non-verbal type of communications. A good customer service executive will pay special attention to them and will ensure that you leave satisfied! Hiring good customer service executives, who have great interpersonal skills, is the sign of a good organization which is focused on customer satisfaction.

3) Written Communications - There are many ways that written communications can be used. The number of ways is ever increasing with the penetration of smartphones and the internet. One of the most common forms of written communications used till date is Email. But slowly, written type of communications is becoming more informal with Whatsapp and other online messaging apps being used regularly.

All different forms of written communication can be formal or informal. If today, we visit a court of law, you will find that even Whatsapp messages are considered to be legal in nature. In fact, there have been so many

cases of celebrities brought under the scanner because of wrong written communications on their social media account.

Thus, the above example is further proof that written communication needs to be used safely and effectively. In fact, written communication between friends can be informal but this type of communication between working professionals should always be formal so that any misquoted words are not misused with ill intent.

The advantage of written communication is that it acts as the final word once a decision has been taken. When you quote your prices to the customer, when you rank a dealer on top, when you promote an employee or when you launch a new product, you use written communication to communicate the update to your team and your employees.

A problem with written communication is that it becomes too formal and might incite ego or various political problems when written communication is used. Newspapers are perfect examples of written words which create controversy.

There is a very apt quotation “Words are mightier than swords”. A wrong email delivered in the wrong hands can cause the world to turn upside down. The many emails and documents released by Edward Snowden which brought the US government under the scanner, are perfect examples of how to use written documents safely and privately otherwise they can bring a whole organization tumbling down (whether justified or not is a different discussion)

4) Formal & Informal - There are two types of communication when considering the formality of the communication. One is the formal and

official type of communication which can be emails, letterheads, memos, reports and other such kinds of written material. These are considered as documentary evidence and certain formality is associated with them. You cannot submit such formal documents and later deny them.

Informal communication is one where there is nothing official about the communication that is happening. It can be known as Grapevine communication. There is no specific channel of informal communication because there is Social media, Whatsapp, SMS which are all vehicles of informal communication which can be used by people.

Advantages of formal communication

- When you want to finalize policy and want to decide a course to adopt, then formal communication is more effective
- Formal communication can help in establishing procedures and ensuring that the steps are followed.
- Any promises or any official plans need to be formally documented so that they can be referred to later.

Advantages of informal communication

- Informal communication helps the “Open door policy” and makes people more confident and forthcoming with their ideas and creativity.
- Informal communication does not incite fear into peoples mind
- Informal talks encourage people to share their problems.

The problem with formal communication is that it is not personal and a distance is maintained if you use only formal communications. Whereas on the other hand, informal conversations can get out of hand and there can be negative grapevine generated.

5) Visual Communication - One of the industries which most prominently uses Visual communication is the medical industry. New medicines which come into the market have to be shown to doctors and the advantages have to be explained. At such times, the medical representatives carry informative pamphlets which are shown to the doctors and dropped with the doctors.

These informative pamphlets have all the information about the medicine so that doctors can feel confident in suggesting the medicine to their patients. Similarly, many different industries are using visual communication to help interaction with their customers so that they can communicate their ideas better. Explainer videos as a concept is rising and is becoming as one of the best types of communication observed on websites.

There are many elements in visual communication that can be used by marketers or companies.

- Colors (such as brand colors)
- Design (logo and brand design)
- Advertising
- Animations
- Illustrations
- Typography
- Presentations
- Video resume's

In person to person communication too visual communication plays a role. Consider the diagrams made by teachers on blackboards when explaining a concept to a class of students. Or we can also take the example of graphs

made in powerpoint by managers when doing a powerpoint presentation to a team of executives or seniors.

To summarize, the type of communication most common are

In teams:

- Formal Communication
- Verbal Communication and Non-verbal communication
- Written communication
- Visual communication

In group of people:

- Informal Communication
- Verbal and Non-verbal communication
- Informal written communications

Above were all the different types of communications used by a group of people or between the team.

Modes of Communication

1. Interpersonal
2. Interpretive
3. Presentational

THREE MODES OF COMMUNICATION

Interpersonal	Interpretive	Presentational
Two-way communication with active negotiation of meaning among individuals	One-way communication with no recourse to the active negotiation of meaning with the writer, speaker, or producer	One-way communication intended for an audience of readers, listeners, or viewers
Spontaneous Usually involves exchange of information Meaningful	Reader, listener or viewer interprets what the author, speaker, or producer wants the receiver of the message to understand	Presentation of information; not exchange No direct opportunity for the active negotiation of meaning exists

Participants observe and monitor one another to see how their meanings and intentions are being communicated and make adjustments and clarifications accordingly	Interpretation differs from comprehension and translation in that it implies the ability to read, listen or view “between the lines,” including understanding from within the cultural mindset or perspective	To ensure the intended audience is successful in its interpretation, the “presenter” needs knowledge of the audience’s language and culture
Speaking and listening (conversation) Reading and writing (text messages, messages on social media, letters)	Reading of authentic texts (websites, stories and other literature, articles, signs) Listening to authentic texts (speeches, messages, songs, radio news, ads) Viewing of authentic materials (videos, movies, presentations, TV shows, commercials, news, plays)	Writing (messages, articles, advertisements, flyers, brochures, short stories, reports, scripts, Power Point presentations); Speaking (telling a story, giving a speech, TV or radio news, drama presentations including skits, presentation to jury)

UNIT-2

LANGUAGE OF COMMUNICATION

Verbal and Non-Verbal - Communication – Written, Oral & Non-Verbal Communication!

1. Verbal Communication – Written, Oral:

The word verbal means ‘connected with words and use of words.’ Any communication using words is verbal communication. Words are the most precise and powerful sets of symbols. Words denote as well as connote meanings. That is why all serious or formal communication is usually in words. Words, as we are all aware, can be written or spoken.

Thus, verbal communication can further be divided into two types:

(a) Oral Communication: “A wound inflicted by speech is more painful than a wound inflicted by a sword”. As the term itself suggests, communication through the spoken word is known as oral communication. Of the working time spent in verbal communication : 9 % is in writing, 16 % in reading, 30 % in speaking and 45 % in listening.

In oral communication, words should be chosen very carefully so that what they connote has the precise shade of meaning. The sender of the message or his representative is usually the speaker, while the receiver or his representative, the listener. Listening is also an important aspect of oral communication.

Factors in oral communication:

(i) The speaker

- (ii) How he speaks
- (iii) What he speaks
- (iv) To whom he speaks
- (v) Whether he receives a feedback

Pre-requisites of oral communication:

- (i) Clear and proper pronunciation of words
- (ii) Clarity and exactitude
- (iii) Conciseness
- (iv) Right tone
- (v) Right style and vocabulary

Merits of oral communication:

(i) Saving of time and money: Oral communication saves money as well as time. No money needs to be spent for producing oral communication since it involves only the spoken word. Oral communication is, therefore, economical.

Secondly, there is hardly any delay from the time when the sender sends the message and the receiver receives it. The words are received and understood as soon as they are spoken. Oral communication, therefore, saves time, too.

(ii) Immediate feedback: The feedback in most oral communication is immediate. The words are received as soon as they are spoken, and the receiver can also give his reaction immediately. The speaker can gauge the mood and the response of the listener. The immediate feedback is an advantage for the speaker.

(iii) Saves paperwork: Paperwork is minimal since communication is in the form of spoken words.

(iv) An effective tool for exhortation: When the communication is oral, you can try to persuade the listener. Doubts can be cleared immediately.

(v) Builds a healthy climate: A friendly atmosphere is created when you communicate orally since there is less formality. You can also make modifications in the communication immediately on the basis of the feedback and response from the listener.

(vi) Best tool during emergency: Oral communication is the quickest tool during an emergency. It is the best method of communication when an immediate and fast response is critical.

Demerits of oral communication (limitations):

(i) Greater chances of misunderstanding: Unless it is recorded, you cannot refer to an oral message again. There are, therefore, greater chances of a message being misunderstood or misinterpreted. In fact, there is also a chance that the message may not be understood at all.

(ii) Bad speaker: Only an individual who can satisfy all the requisites of effective oral communication can produce good results. More often than not, a bad speaker may send the wrong message. When speaking, one communicates through the articulation, voice modulation and body language, too.

A message may be misunderstood if there is a disharmony among these components. Also, as mentioned earlier, what the words connote and what they denote should be in harmony, else the message may lead to a conflict in understanding.

(iii) Ineffective for lengthy communication: Oral communication is not useful for lengthy communication. Because of human limitations, there is every likelihood that something important will be missed out.

(iv) Lower retention rate: Oral communication suffers from the drawback of a low retention rate. A listener may absorb only some part of an oral message since the attention span differs from person to person. People also tend to forget an oral message quickly.

(v) No legal validity: Oral communication lacks proof of record. There is no permanent record or proof of what has been said. An individual who has given a message may deny it later; similarly, an individual who has been given an oral message or instruction may say he never received it. Hence, oral communication has very little value from the legal point of view.

(vi) Difficult to fix responsibility: Since a message is transmitted orally, it is difficult to fix responsibility. This may also lead to carelessness in the implementation of a message.

(b) Written communication:

A message constitutes written communication when it is put in “black and white.” It is a formal type of communication. The sender of the message or his representative constitutes the writer.

Written communication is usually considered binding on business organizations and is often used as evidence. Technological advancement has enlarged the gamut of written communication through email and other such facilities.

Factors in written communication:

- (i) The writer
- (ii) The content
- (iii) The language used
- (iv) The purpose of the communication
- (v) The style adopted – formal or friendly
- (vi) The receiver

Pre-requisites of written communication:

- (i) How much to put in writing
- (ii) What to leave out
- (iii) When to stop
- (iv) When to convey
- (v) By what means to convey

Merits:

(i) Precise and accurate: Written communication is generally prepared with great care and precision. The very prospect of writing makes a person conscious. You have to be very serious and organised while communicating in the written form, because written communication is open to verification.

(ii) Easily verified: Since written communication is on paper etc., it can be read and re-read. It also offers itself to verification. There is also, thus, less 'chance of someone twisting the message to his or her own advantage.

(iii) Permanent record: Written communication constitutes a permanent record. It also acts like evidence. It proves very useful for future reference as it can be preserved for years. For example, old orders and decisions can serve as the basis for new ones.

(iv) Suitable for lengthy and complicated messages: Lengthy and complicated messages can be understood better when they are in the written form rather than in the oral. There is less chance of misinterpretation and misunderstanding. Also, the language used is less subject to change.

(v) Responsibility can be easily fixed: In written communication, responsibilities of sender and receiver can be fixed easily. People have the tendency of shifting responsibilities for mistakes, but this is difficult if the onus is obvious in black and white.

(vi) Has legal validity: Written communication is acceptable as a legal document. Written communication has been used as evidence since time immemorial.

Demerits:

(i) Slower method of communication: Written communication can be time-consuming since it may take even two or even three days to reach the receiver (by letters, for instance). By contrast, oral communication is immediate.

(ii) Further delay if clarifications are required: Written communication hampers quick clarifications. The receiver may write back for clarifications and wait for a reply, making the process tedious. Even if clarifications are not needed, there is still a delay between the time the sender writes a message and the receiver receives it.

(iii) Leads to too much of paperwork: Since written communication is basically done on paper, one may tend to use it as escape mechanism. Paper-free offices remain a dream.

(iv) Always a possibility of ambiguity or lack of comprehensibility: It is quite possible that the receiver is not able to comprehend the exact meaning of a written message that he has received. The clarity of a written message also depends upon the skill, or the lack of it, in the sender. If the message has not been written properly, it will not be understood, either.

(v) Costly in terms of money and man-hours: Writing letters is a costly process not only because you need to spend money on postage, but also because several persons are involved in the process of sending out a letter from an organization. Their time costs organization money. While oral communication can be short and quick, written communication, because of its very nature, tends to be lengthy.

(vi) No flexibility: The written word is not subject to instant change after communication. Therefore, conveying an afterthought may prove very lengthy, and, at times, even impossible.

(vii) Literacy essential: It goes without saying that in written communication, the sender as well as the receiver should be literate. In fact, we may wrongly presume that they are so. In many Asian Countries,

where literacy is low, a written message will be meaningless for large masses of illiterate persons.

Literacy also means literacy in the language of the message. The receiver should know the language in which a message has been written. It is no use receiving a message in English if you are not conversant with that language.

Notwithstanding its limitations, it can be safely concluded that written communication remains the spine of an organisation. Almost all formal communication is in the written form.

TOP 10 ESSENTIAL SKILLS FOR EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Being able to communicate effectively is an essential skill. Whether it's in our business life or our personal relationships, effective communication is the key to our success. Here are my top ten essential skills for effective communication. Master these skills now, and they'll serve you well for a long time to come!

1. Listening

One of the most important aspects of effective communication is being a good listener. People do not like communicating with others who are only interested in telling you what they want to tell you, and don't listen to what you have to say. Effective communication requires active listening, so practice active listening until it becomes second nature to you.

So what is active listening? Active listening involves hearing and understanding what a person is saying to you. Unless you understand

clearly what a person is telling you, you can't respond appropriately. Gain clarification by asking questions or rephrase what you're being told, so that you're sure you fully understand the message that's being conveyed to you. For example, you could say "So, what you're saying is..."

2. Be Clear and Be Concise

Convey your message using as few words as possible. Whether in person, via telephone, or email, convey your message clearly, concise and direct. If you are excessive with your words, the listener will either lose focus or just be unsure as to what it is that you want. Before speaking give some thought as to the message you want to convey. This will prevent you rambling and causing confusion.

3. Be Personable

When communicating face to face with someone, use a friendly tone with a simple smile, and ask a personal question. These things encourage the other person to engage in honest, open communication. When using written communication (e.g. email), you can achieve this by adding a simple personal message, for example, "How was your weekend?".

4. Be Confident

Confidence underpins all effective communication. Other people will believe you will do as you say if you sound confident. Making eye contact, using a firm but friendly tone (never aggressive), are all ways you can exude confidence. Remember to always be listening to the other person and looking out for those nonverbal clues.

5. Be Actionable

The final important element of professional communication is action. Especially in my position as project manager, it is important that the people I work with always know what to expect after we talk. At the end of every

discussion, I try to quickly recap everyone's next steps, making sure that everyone understands and agrees upon what will happen next. If we have different understandings of the expected result of the conversation, this recap ensures that everyone is on the same page at the end of the exchange.

6. Empathy

Empathy is the skill of being able to understand and share the feelings of another person.

Even if don't agree with the person you're communicating with, it's very important that you understand and respect their view. Simply saying to that person "I understand what you're saying", will let them know that you have been listening to them, and that you respect their point of view.

7. Always Have An Open Mind

Being an effective communicator requires that every conversation is approached with a flexible, open mind. This isn't always easy to achieve, but is very important to communicating effectively. Always engage in active listening, and be sure to demonstrate empathy by acknowledging you understand what the other person's point of view is. Adopting this approach will always ensure honest, productive communication.

8. Convey Respect

Other people will be more likely to engage in communication with you if you respect them and their ideas. Simply addressing another person using their name, will make them feel appreciated. If communicating via telephone, always keep focused on the conversation and avoid being distracted in any way. When communicating through email, take time to construct and edit your message, taking care to address the recipient by name.

9. Give and Receive Feedback

Giving and receiving appropriate feedback is an essential communication skill, particularly for those of us whose roles include managing other people. Providing constructive feedback, as well as giving someone praise, can greatly increase motivation and build morale.

It is just as important that you accept and encourage feedback from others. Always listen to feedback and act positively on it. If you're unsure about any aspect of the feedback, simply ask a question to gain clarification from the other person.

10. Consider The Best Medium for The Job!

The final item on my list is knowing what the best form of communication is to use. Being mindful of using the best form of communication will result in your response being a positive one. Consider things such as, who it is you're trying to communicate with, how important the topic is, and how busy that person might be. For example, asking your boss for a raise is never going to be taken seriously if you do it by text – so consider what's appropriate!

11. Use of Non-Verbal Communication

The words we choose make up just 7% of the message being conveyed, which makes non-verbal communication all the more important. Body language is an important communication tool. Your body language should help convey your words. Other factors you should consider are things like the tone of your voice, your hand gestures, and ensuring eye contact.

A person is going to be encouraged to speak openly with you if you are relaxed and have a friendly tone. Adopt an open stance position, with relaxed legs and open arms. It is important that you make eye contact with the person you are communicating with, but be careful that you do not stare at them, as this is just uncomfortable. It is just as important that you recognise the non-verbal signals being displayed by the other

person. These signals will give you an insight into how that person is feeling.

Effective Communication: Barriers and Strategies

Some basic skills can help you to be a more effective communicator in the classroom. This Teaching Tip explores:

- Barriers to listening and strategies for effective listening;
- Barriers to accurate perception and strategies for accurate perception; and,
- Barriers to effective verbal communication and strategies for effective verbal communication.

Barriers to listening

- **Focusing on a personal agenda.** When we spend our listening time formulating our next response, we cannot be fully attentive to what the speaker is saying.
- **Experiencing information overload.** Too much stimulation or information can make it very difficult to listen with full attention. Try to focus on the relevant information, and the central points that are being conveyed.
- **Criticizing the speaker.** Do not be distracted by critical evaluations of the speaker. Focus on what they are saying - the message - rather than the messenger.
- **Getting distracted by emotional noise.** We react emotionally to certain words, concepts and ideas, and to a myriad of other cues from speakers (appearance, non-verbal cues such as gestures, etc.). Make a conscious effort to quiet your own emotional reactions so that you can listen properly.
- **Getting distracted by external “noise”.** Audible noise may be extremely distracting. Some things can be minimized – e.g., turn down the ringer on your phone, and notifications on your phone or computer while meeting with someone. Other noises may be unavoidable – e.g., construction, other people. Also, there may be figurative “noise” from the external environment, such as distracting or inappropriate decor in a room, or environmental conditions such as the room being too hot or cold.
- **Experiencing physical difficulty.** Feeling physically unwell, or experiencing pain can make it very difficult to listen effectively. You may wish to communicate that this is not a good time, and reschedule the discussion.

Strategies for active listening

The following strategies are intended to promote active listening, or a type of listening with the goal to “develop a clear understanding of the speaker’s concern and also to clearly communicate the listener’s interest in the speaker’s message” (McNaughton, Hamlin, McCarthy, Head-Reeves, & Schreiner, 2008, p. 224).

- **Stop.** Focus on the other person, their thoughts and feelings. Consciously focus on quieting your own internal commentary, and step away from your own concerns to think about those of the speaker. Give your full attention to the speaker.
- **Look.** Pay attention to non-verbal messages, without letting yourself be distracted. Notice body language and non-verbal cues to allow for a richer understanding of the speaker’s point. Remember that “active listeners need to communicate to the speaker that they are involved and giving the person unconditional attention” (Weger, Castle, & Emmett, 2010, p. 35).
- **Listen.** Listen for the essence of the speaker’s thoughts: details, major ideas and their meanings. Seek an overall understanding of what the speaker is trying to communicate, rather than reacting to the individual words or terms that they use to express themselves.
- **Be empathetic.** Imagine how you would feel in their circumstances. Be empathetic to the feelings of the speaker, while maintaining a calm centre within yourself. You need not be drawn into all of their problems or issues, as long as you acknowledge what they are experiencing.
- **Ask questions.** Use questions to clarify your understanding, as well as to demonstrate interest in what is being said.
- **Paraphrase.** If you don’t have any specific questions to ask, you may choose to repeat back to the speaker, in your own words, what you have taken away, in order to allow the speaker to clarify any points (Weger et al., 2010).

Barriers to accurate perception

- **Stereotyping and generalizing.** Be careful not to hold on to preconceptions about people or things. We often have a tendency to see what we want to see, forming an impression from a small amount of information or one experience, and assuming that to be highly representative of the whole person or situation.
- **Not investing time.** Making assumptions and ignoring details or circumstances can lead to misconceptions. When we fail to look in-depth for causes or circumstances, we miss important details, and do not allow for the complexity of the situation.
- **Having a distorted focus.** Focusing on the negative aspects of a conversation or a situation is a habit common to many people. Even though we may recognize the positive things, we often give more weight to the negative, allowing one negative comment to overshadow numerous positive ones.
- **Assuming similar interpretations.** Not everyone will draw the same conclusions from a given situation or set of information. Everybody interprets things differently. Make sure to check for other people's interpretations, and be explicit about your own.
- **Experiencing incongruent cues.** As speakers, and as listeners, we are constantly and simultaneously sending cues and receiving them from other people. Try to be consistent with your verbal cues and your body language. Do not say one thing and express something else through your body language. Be aware of how your non-verbal communication relates to your spoken words. If someone else seems to be sending a double message — by saying one thing and expressing something else in their body language — ask for clarification.

Strategies for accurate perception

- **Analyze your own perceptions.** Question your perceptions, and think about how they are formed. Check in with others around you regularly, and be aware of assumptions that you are making. Seek additional information and

observations. You may just need to ask people if your perceptions are accurate.

- **Work on improving your perception.** Increase your awareness of barriers to perception, and which ones you tend towards. Check in with yourself regularly. Seek honest, constructive feedback from others regarding their perceptions of you as a means of increasing your selfawareness.
- **Focus on others.** Develop your ability to focus on other people, and understand them better by trying to gather knowledge about them, listening to them actively, and imagining how you would feel in their situation.

Barriers to effective verbal communication

- **Lacking clarity.** Avoid abstract, overly-formal language, colloquialisms, and jargon, which obscure your message more than they serve to impress people.
- **Using stereotypes and generalizations.** Speakers who make unqualified generalizations undermine their own clarity and credibility. Be careful not to get stuck in the habit of using stereotypes, or making generalizations about complex systems or situations. Another form of generalization is “polarization” or creating extremes. Try to be sensitive to the complexities of situations, rather than viewing the world in black and white.
- **Jumping to conclusions.** Confusing facts with inferences is a common tendency. Do not assume you know the reasons behind events, or that certain facts necessarily have certain implications. Make sure you have all the information you can get, and then speak clearly about the facts versus the meanings or interpretations you attach to those.
- **Dysfunctional responses.** Ignoring or not responding to a comment or question quickly undermines effective communication. Likewise, responding with an irrelevant comment -- one that isn't connected to the topic at hand -- will quash genuine communication. Interrupting others while they are speaking also creates a poor environment for communication.

- **Lacking confidence.** Lacking confidence can be a major barrier to effective communication. Shyness, difficulty being assertive, or low self-worth can hinder your ability to make your needs and opinions known. Also, a lack of awareness of your own rights and opportunities in a given situation can prevent you from expressing your needs openly. See Eison (1990)'s "Confidence in the Classroom: Ten Maxims for New Teachers" for a set of maxims to think about when reflecting on your own confidence as a communicator.

Strategies for effective verbal communication

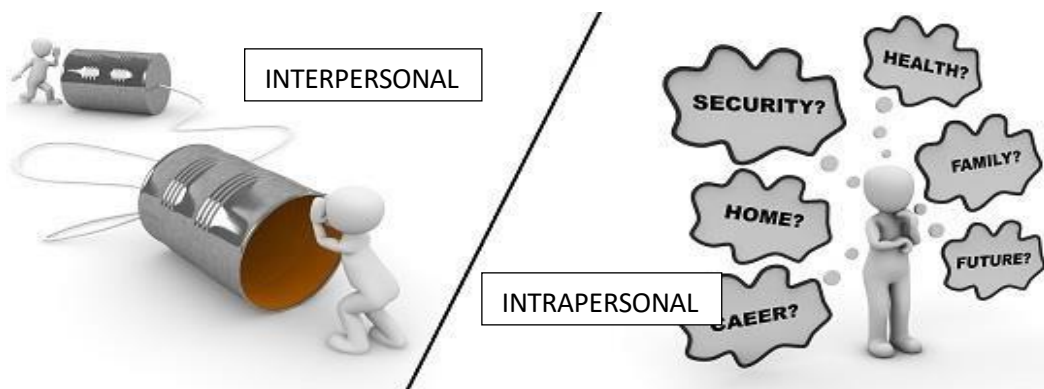
- **Focus on the issue, not the person.** Try not to take everything personally, and similarly, express your own needs and opinions in terms of the job at hand. Solve problems rather than attempt to control others. For example, rather than ignoring a student who routinely answers questions in class with inappropriate tangents, speak with the student outside of class about how this might disrupt the class and distract other students.
- **Be genuine rather than manipulative.** Be yourself, honestly and openly. Be honest with yourself, and focus on working well with the people around you, and acting with integrity.
- **Empathize rather than remain detached.** Although professional relationships entail some boundaries when it comes to interaction with colleagues, it is important to demonstrate sensitivity, and to really care about the people you work with. If you don't care about them, it will be difficult for them to care about you when it comes to working together.
- **Be flexible towards others.** Allow for other points of view, and be open to other ways of doing things. Diversity brings creativity and innovation.
- **Value yourself and your own experiences.** Be firm about your own rights and needs. Undervaluing yourself encourages others to undervalue you, too. Offer your ideas and expect to be treated well.
- **Use affirming responses.** Respond to other in ways that acknowledge their experiences. Thank them for their input. Affirm their right to their feelings,

even if you disagree. Ask questions, express positive feeling; and provide positive feedback when you can.

INTRAPERSONAL, INTERPERSONAL AND GROUP COMMUNICATION

Intrapersonal & Interpersonal Communication:

As the term, 'intra' means 'within', so the communication that takes place within a person is called intrapersonal communication. On the other hand, the term 'inter' means 'between', so when the communication occurs between two or more persons, it is said to be interpersonal communication.



We, humans, are social animals, and we always need someone to talk or share our opinions, news, and even feelings. Communication is a substantial part of our life, whether we say something or not, it automatically conveys a message to the persons surrounding us, because it is inescapable. It can be intrapersonal communication or interpersonal communication. The major difference between intrapersonal and interpersonal communication is that the former is invisible, as it goes in our mind, the latter is visible as it takes place between several parties.

Definition of Intrapersonal Communication

The communication with oneself is intrapersonal communication. It involves thinking, analyzing, interpreting, assessing, contemplating, feeling, etc. It is to reflect the individual self, with a view to clarifying something.

It is an activity that takes place in our mind; wherein a person is involved in a conversation with himself/herself, commonly known as 'self-talk' or 'inner speech'. The activity can be a monologue or internal dialogue, i.e. when you imagine a conversation, in your mind with the absent other.

So, it is quite obvious that the sender and receiver are the same person. Internal discourse, Solo-vocal communication and Solo written communication are the three levels of intrapersonal communication. The three aspects that govern the intrapersonal communication are:

- **Self-Concept:** Self-concept ascertains the way an individual takes himself/herself, oriented towards others. The three factors in self-concept are – Belief, Value and Attitude.
- **Perception:** It is what the mind receives and grasp from the outside world.

Definition of Interpersonal Communication

Interpersonal Communication is the one to one communication between two or more persons, wherein exchange of ideas, information or messages takes place through a channel. It can be a face to face communication between parties, communication over mail, telephone and the like. In Interpersonal Communication, the way something is said is as important as what is being said. So, here, the tone of voice, body language, gestures, facial expressions, have a great impact on the recipient. The features of interpersonal communication are as under:

- **Inescapable:** Whenever we try not to say anything to anyone at all, it says something about our mood, attitude or nature, i.e. not by words but through the non-verbal signals.
- **Irreversible or Unrepeatable:** Once something is being said, it cannot be taken back, so neither it is reversible nor repeatable.
- **Complex:** Due to some variables involved in communication, it is a complex process. The words used in the process of communication may not have the same meaning for both sender and receiver, and this complicates the process.
- **Contextual:** Context plays a significant role in the communication process, as in there is psychological, environmental, situational and relational context.

BASIS FOR COMPARISON	INTRAPERSONAL COMMUNICATION	INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION
Meaning	Intrapersonal Communication is one, that we have with ourselves, i.e. the communication that occurs in our mind.	Interpersonal Communication is the communication between two or more person, through verbal or non-verbal messages.
Persons Involved	One	At least two
Occurrence	Continuous due to human nature.	Regular, due to social needs.
Media	Only a person's internal senses are involved.	Supported by a verbal and non-verbal media.
Concerned with	Thinking and Analysis	Exchanging and sharing of ideas or information

Group Communication:

Group communication is an extension of interpersonal communication where more than two individuals are involved in exchange of ideas, skills and interests. A group is a number of people with a common goal who interact with one another to accomplish their goals, recognize one another's existence and see themselves as part of the group. Groups provide an opportunity for people to come together to discuss and exchange views of common interest. There could be many different groups for as many different reasons. For instance, casually formed groups with friends over a drink, coffee break, games, dances or religious gatherings have a different purpose than that of groups attending a meeting or seminar to help fight Drug Abuse or interacting with committee members to draft a proposal.

Communication in a group, small or big, serves many goals including collective decision-making, self-expression, increasing one's effect, elevating one's status and relaxation. **Group communication** is considered effective as it provides an opportunity for direct interaction among the

members of the group; it helps in bringing about changes in attitudes and beliefs. **Group communication** has limitations too, as group interaction is time consuming and often inefficient, especially in an emergency. Besides, imbalances in status, skills and goals, may distort the process and the outcome sharply.



Group communication is a mode of communication in an organization, between employers and employees, and employees in teams/groups. Group communication can further be looked from an marketing perspective as communicating to a group of people or target customers in order to market a product.

Small group communications can be looked at as groups of size 3 to 20. And larger groups looked can be of sizes 100 to 200 in size. Group communication can be effective, when there is a specific purpose to the communication, a proper means of communication, and content of the communication suitable to the target audience, and a proper communicator who can drive the initiative and process.

Group communication can be of various media channels, like social media, digital media, print media, speeches and focus group communication etc. The choice of the means of communication depends on factors like the target audience, the means and availability of the communication mode, cost implication for the communication initiative.

Groups have been classified as small groups and large groups. A small group comprises of three to seven members. Small groups are informal and less structured. Larger groups adopt formal rules to maintain order. There is more chance for individual participation in small groups. Also small groups are easy to manage and are more efficient in accomplishing tasks and making decisions. Most researchers define a small group as having at least three and no more than twelve or fifteen members.

A group needs to have at least three members; otherwise it would simply be a dyad. With three members, coalitions can be formed and some kind of organization is present. Too large of a group (more than twelve or fifteen members) inhibits the group members' ability to communicate with everyone else in the group. Members must be able to communicate freely and openly with all of the other members of the group. Groups will develop norms about discussion and group members will develop roles, which will affect the group's interaction. A group must have a common purpose or goal and they must work together to achieve that goal. The goal brings the group together and holds it together through conflict and tension.

UNIT-3

WHAT IS CLOSED READING?

Close reading is a thoughtful, disciplined reading of a text. Also called *close analysis* and *explication de texte*.

: THE detailed and careful analysis of a written work

also : the product of such analysis'

When your teachers or professors ask you to analyze a literary text, they often look for something frequently called close reading. Close reading is deep analysis of how a literary text works; it is both a reading process and something you include in a literary analysis paper, though in a refined form.

Close reading sometimes feels like over-analyzing, but don't worry. Close reading is a process of finding as much information as you can in order to form as many questions as you can. When it is time to write your paper and formalize your close reading, you will sort through your work to figure out what is most convincing and helpful to the argument you hope to make and, conversely, what seems like a stretch. This guide imagines you are sitting down to read a text for the first time on your way to developing an argument about a text and writing a paper. To give one example of how to do this, we will read the poem "Design" by famous American poet Robert Frost and attend to four major components of literary texts: subject, form, word choice (diction), and theme.

Close reading is thoughtful, critical analysis of a text that focuses on significant details or patterns in order to develop a deep, precise understanding of the text's form, craft, meanings, etc. It is a key requirement of the Common Core State Standards and directs the reader's attention to the text itself.

Close reading includes:

- ❑ Using short passages and excerpts
 - ❑ Diving right into the text with limited pre-reading activities
 - ❑ Focusing on the text itself
 - ❑ Rereading deliberately
 - ❑ Reading with a pencil
 - ❑ Noticing things that are confusing
 - ❑ Discussing the text with others
 - Think-Pair Share or Turn and Talk frequently
-

- Small groups and whole class
 - Responding to text-dependent questions
-

COMPREHENSION

Comprehension is the ability to understand and get meaning from spoken and written language. Comprehension is comprised of a complex process involving knowledge, experience, thinking, and teaching. Therefore, effective comprehension instruction is necessary to help students understand, remember, and communicate with others about what is read to them and what they read.

Comprehension skills are based on rich language and experience with text from early in life.

1. Learning how to decode;
 2. becoming fluent in decoding with an extensive repertoire (collection) of sight words;
 3. increasing vocabulary to include words commonly found in texts; and
-

4. learning how to get meaning from text using comprehension processes

Student engagement in discussions about text results in higher-level thinking skills, improved reading comprehension, and increased motivation (Almasi, McKeown, & Beck, 1996; Gambrell, 1996). The research also indicates that:

- Reading comprehension is the product of decoding skills and language comprehension skills
- Some children decode words fluently and still have reading comprehension problems that seem to stem from language comprehension
- Studies of exemplary primary-grade teachers indicate that a focus on comprehension as well as word identification and decoding skills is beneficial
- Students learn to interact with text through read alouds that incorporate explicit instruction, teacher modeling, and scaffolding that encourage students to be metacognitive while reading
- Knowledge and understanding of text structure assists in comprehension of the text. When students are familiar with text structure, they organize the text as they read, which helps them recognize and retain the important information

Comprehension Strategies

Research studies on reading and comprehension have shown that highly proficient readers utilize a number of different strategies to comprehend various types of texts, strategies that can also be used by less proficient readers in order to improve their comprehension.

1. **Making Inferences:** In everyday terms we refer to this as “reading between the lines”. It involves connecting various parts of texts that it isn’t directly linked in order to form a sensible conclusion. A form of assumption, the reader speculates what connections lie within the texts.
2. **Planning and Monitoring:** This strategy centers around the reader’s mental awareness and their ability to control their comprehension by way of awareness. By previewing text (via outlines, table of contents, etc.) one can establish a goal for reading-“what do I need to get out of this”? Readers use context clues and other evaluation strategies to clarify texts and ideas, and this monitoring their level of understanding.
3. **Asking Questions:** To solidify one understands of passages of texts readers inquire and develop their own opinion of the author’s writing, character motivations, relationships, etc. This strategy involves allowing oneself to be completely objective in order to find various meanings within the text.
4. **Determining Importance:** Pinpointing the important ideas and messages within the text. Readers are taught to identify direct and indirect ideas and to summarize the relevance of each.
5. **Visualizing:** With this sensory-driven strategy readers form mental and visual images of the contents of text. Being able to connect visually allows for a better understanding with the text through emotional responses.
6. **Synthesizing:** This method involves marrying multiple ideas from various texts in order to draw conclusions and make comparisons across different texts; with the reader’s goal being to understand how they all fit together.
7. **Making Connections:** A cognitive approach also referred to as “reading beyond the lines”, which involves (A) finding a personal connection to reading, such as personal experience, previously read texts, etc. to help establish a deeper understanding of the context of the text, or (B)

thinking about implications that have no immediate connection with the theme of the text.[\[37\]](#)

SUMMARY PARAPHRASING

How to Write a Summary by Paraphrasing Source Material

When you paraphrase material from a source, you restate the information from an entire sentence or passage in your own words, using your own original sentence structure. A paraphrased source differs from a summarized source in that you focus on restating the ideas, not condensing them.

It is important to check your paraphrase against the source material to make sure it is both accurate and original. Inexperienced writers sometimes use the thesaurus method of paraphrasing—that is, they simply rewrite the source material, replacing most of the words with synonyms. This constitutes a misuse of sources. A true paraphrase restates ideas using the writer’s own language and style. Instruction on how to paraphrase:

- Write a Summary the way you always have, i.e., selecting “word-for-word” passages from the essay included in this module. Cite the page numbers in parentheses as you have up to now.
- Make a copy of your summary and place it below the original. Go into the copy of your summary and *try to paraphrase each “word-for-word” passage that you cited.*
- When writing a summary, remember that it should be in the form of a paragraph.
- A summary begins with an introductory sentence that states the text’s title, author and main point of the text as you see it.
- A summary is written in your own words.
- A summary contains only the ideas of the original text. Do not insert any of your own opinions, interpretations, deductions or comments into a summary.

- Identify in order the significant sub-claims the author uses to defend the main point.
- Using source material from the essay is important. Why? Because defending claims with source material is what you will be asked to do when writing papers for your college professors.
- Write a last sentence that “wraps” up your summary; often a simple rephrasing of the main point.

Example Paraphrase Writing Format

In the essay *Santa Ana*, author Joan Didion’s main point is (*state main point*). According to Didion ...*PARAPHRASE 1*...”. Didion also CLAIMS... *PARAPHRASE 2*...”. Finally, she CLAIMS “...*PARAPHRASE 3*...” Write a last sentence that “wraps” up your summary; often a simple rephrasing of the main point.

PARAPHRASE AND SUMMARY

Paraphrase and summary are different writing strategies that ask you to put the argument of the author in your own words. This can help you better understand what the writer is saying, so that you can communicate that message to your own reader without relying only on quotes. Paraphrases are used for short passages and specific claims in an argument, while summaries are used for entire pieces and focus on capturing the big picture of an argument. Both should be cited using the appropriate format (MLA, APA, etc.).

Paraphrase

When you paraphrase, using your own words, you are explaining one of the claims of your source's argument, following its line of reasoning and its sequence of ideas. The purpose of a paraphrase is to convey the meaning of the original message and, in doing so, to prove that you

understand the passage well enough to restate it. The paraphrase should give the reader an accurate understanding of the author's position on the topic. Your job is to uncover and explain all the facts and arguments involved in your subject. A paraphrase tends to be about the same length or a little shorter than the thing being paraphrased.

- Alters the wording of the passage without changing its meaning.
- Retains the basic logic of the argument.
- Retains the basic sequence of ideas.
- Can even retain the basic examples used in the passage.
- Most importantly, it accurately conveys the author's meaning and opinion.

Summary

A summary covers the main points of the writer's argument in your own words. Summaries are generally much shorter than the original source, since they do not contain any specific examples or pieces of evidence. The goal of a summary is to give the reader a clear idea of what the source is arguing, without going into any specifics about what they are using to argue their point.

In your own words:

- State the thesis
- Main claims of their argument
- conclusion of the original material

In both the paraphrase and summary, the author's meaning and opinion are retained. However, in the case of the summary, examples and illustrations are omitted. Summaries can be tremendously helpful because they can be used to encapsulate everything from a long narrative passage of an essay, to a chapter in a book, to an entire book.

UNIT-4

DOCUMENTING

A document (noun) is a piece of information that one can use for communicating something. In most of the cases it is a paper, that contains information in the form of ink marks. But nowadays documents can be digital as well.

Documenting is the art and science of creating, managing and keeping a document.

To document (verb) means to produce an object by collecting and representing information.

Different sorts of documents

Prototypical Documents: Letters, memos, legal forms, Instruction manual

Documents of Record: Newspapers and magazines

Books: Text book, Novels, Recipe books, Encyclopedia, Comic books

Canonical Documents: The Bible, Iliad and Odyssey, Vedas, Ramayana, Mahabharata, Quran, Code of Hammurabi, Tao Te Ching

Transactional Documents: Cheque, Contracts, Prescription, Receipt, Form (document), Postage Stamp

Functional Documents: PDF files, PostScript files, XML files, Email

Non-Prototypical Documents: Post-it notes, Fortune cookie strips, Maps, Paintings, milk cartons, cereal boxes

Non-Classical Digital Documents: Web Page, Weblog, Wiki

MAKING NOTES

Making notes is essential. The act of writing or recording notes helps motor, visual and auditory recall. This makes the subject easier to remember. You can learn more about note-taking in the following section.

Individual styles

Everybody makes notes in their own ways. They are for your purposes so the most important aspect is that they suit your purposes. Your notes may be neat or messy, ordered lists or sprawling webs. This does not matter as long as you can make use of them.

Methods of taking notes

Headings and bullet points

This is a very common way of making notes. It is especially useful if you are making notes on a computer as you can reorganise information under new headings. The heading is the key point or a question. The bullets or list of points under it all refer to that one heading.

Double notes

These are notes where you use either two color or two columns or two sheets of paper in order to make two connected sets of notes. The first set is a summary of what you are reading or hearing. The second set is your commentary upon the first set. This is useful for separating out other people's ideas and words from your own.

Pattern notes

These are notes that are organised around a central concept and work their way out from that idea. Each line from the centre leads you into more depth on a particular theme. Use colour and shape to make the notes distinctive. Look for a particular image formed by the final shape of the notes - or aim to develop a particular image. This will make the notes more memorable.

Annotations

If you own the text, you can highlight key points and write additional information and comments in the margins or underneath. This can save

time making longer notes, but is less effective for processing the information and ensuring that you understand it than other forms of notes.

Summaries

It is useful to summarise your notes on any one topic or questions down to a few key points, quotes and examples. This familiarises you with the material. It also makes it easier to carry the information around to refer to on work placement or to revise for exams.

Lists

These are useful, for example for:

- Identifying all the tasks that have to be undertaken on a particular day.
- Noting the key themes in a book or lecture.
- Numbering key points.
- Being able to see what you need to do or remember very easily.
- Identifying resources to follow up.
- Keep a record of resources such as useful web-pages.

Keep a record of sources

It is important to keep a very good record of where you gained each piece of information so that you can find it again quickly and easily if you need to check something about it. You will also need this information when you make reference to the information in your work. If you do not state where you get ideas, material and quotations, then you may be accused of plagiarism and cheating.

Record the:

- Author's name and initials.
- The full name of the chapter, book or article.
- The name of the journal for printed articles or of the book for chapters.
- The place of publication.
- The date of publication.
- The publisher.
- The shelf reference or web address.
- It is also useful to keep a record of the ISBN number at the back of the book.

Noting down quotations

Take special care when copying quotations. To avoid plagiarism:

- Copy only very small phrases or very short sections to quote in your work.
- Use a different colour pen to copy these.
- Make very few such quotes.
- Write down details of the source of the quotation and reference these in your text and list of references.

Note Making

Note Making is a way of recording important details from a source. This source can be any book, article, [meeting](#) or any oral discussion. In note making, the writer records the essence of the information. It helps us to understand and clarify thinking. Note making saves a lot of time by going through the notes made. One can get a glimpse of a lot of information from a short note.

Advantages of Note Making

A note making is a skill which improves by practicing. There are some advantages of note making. Let us get to know some of them.

- It has great importance in exams or in academic writing
- It is an organization of main points for future use
- Note making helps in keeping the information handy whenever we require
- It helps in recollecting and recalling the past events said or heard
- It helps in concentrating, understanding and provides a permanent record
- Note making format helps a writer to go through bulky documents quicker
- It helps in understanding a material if the notes are in own words
- It distinguishes between main points and details

Note Making Format

There is a fixed note making format. One needs to follow this note making format in order to have a clear and unambiguous understanding from it. The note making format has:

Heading - It shows the title or the heading of note.

Subheading - As the name suggests, a subheading is a subdivision of the main topic. One can use as many subheadings as he or she wants.

Point - Below subheading, there are some points which are the part of the main topics.

Sub-subheading - One can add more headings below the points for showing the category, types, advantages, etc.

Key or Keywords - The key portion of the note shows the various codes, symbols or the abbreviation used. It helps to get a clear understanding of the keys used in the note making format.

The Procedure of Note Making

- Read the passage provided
- Underline the important sentences. It helps to make headings and subheadings
- Make a rough note first so as to get an idea
- Organize them in logical order or sequence for the final note
- Use the appropriate note making format
- Do not change the idea or the message of the passage

Points to Remember for Note Making Format

- Avoid using long sentences as heading or title
- Never lose the main idea of the passage
- Ignore information which is less important
- Be brief, clear, and specific
- Use logical sequencing
- Use proper indentation
- Leave no spaces to avoid confusion
- Do not include your own version or understandings
- Use abbreviations

- Make your note more memorable by adding colors, drawings, and symbols

Note Making Format

A note making involves the selection, analysis, summarization, and organization of information. There are different note making format. Let us make ourselves familiar with them.

Split – page Format (A narrative note making format method)

In this method, the page is divided into two columns. The first column had the standard notes. The second column will have a summary. This is the most common note making format to note down lecture notes.

Diagram / Pattern format (A visual note making format method)

In this method, the information is presented by a diagram. The main topic is linked together by related ideas. This method is visually more appealing and easy to understand.

Mind Map (A visual note making method)

In this method, the main points and all the related points are presented through a map. It contains text and images both. For a clear understanding, the information is linked in the proper sequence.

Outline Format (A visual note making format method)

In this method, the information is presented as an outline. Proper titles and subtitles are numbered accordingly for this outline.

Question and Prompt Format (A visual note making format method)

In this method, the main points are highlighted as a series of questions and appropriate answers. It helps in revising the note in an easy way.

Solved Example for You

Problem: A person really wants to remember the information the speaker is providing. What should he need to do?

1. **Listen for non – verbal clues**
2. **Listen for verbal clues**
3. **Write down the important details**
4. **None of the above**

Solution: 3. Write down the important details.

Problem: Why is it important to take notes?

1. **Helps you remember**
2. **Improves your concentration level**
3. **Helps you prepare for tests**
4. **All of the above**

Solution: 4. All of the above.

Writing Business Letter

Business Letters are mostly formal but also have semi-formal or informal formats or templates.

The look and feel, textual usage of business letter and format depends on the following:

- 1) Purpose of letter (Objective/Subject/Problem addressed)
- 2) Addresser and Addressee - To whom the letter is written to and by whom
- 3) Means of delivery

Parts of a Business Letter

This resource is organized in the order in which you should write a business letter, starting with the sender's address if the letter is not written on letterhead.

Sender's Address

The sender's address usually is included in letterhead. If you are not using letterhead, include the sender's address at the top of the letter one line above the date. Do not write the sender's name or title, as it is included in the letter's closing. Include only the street address, city, and zip code.

Date

The date line is used to indicate the date the letter was written. However, if your letter is completed over a number of days, use the date it was finished in the date line. When writing to companies within the United States, use the American date format. (The United States-based convention for formatting a date places the month before the day. For example: June 11, 2001.) Write out the month, day and year two inches from the top of the page. Depending which format you are using for your letter, either left justify the date or tab to the center

point and type the date. In the latter case, include the sender's address in letterhead, rather than left-justified.

Inside Address

The inside address is the recipient's address. It is always best to write to a specific individual at the firm to which you are writing. If you do not have the person's name, do some research by calling the company or speaking with employees from the company. Include a personal title such as Ms., Mrs., Mr., or Dr. Follow a woman's preference in being addressed as Miss, Mrs., or Ms. If you are unsure of a woman's preference in being addressed, use Ms. If there is a possibility that the person to whom you are writing is a Dr. or has some other title, use that title. Usually, people will not mind being addressed by a higher title than they actually possess. To write the address, use the U.S. Post Office Format. For international addresses, type the name of the country in all-capital letters on the last line. The inside address begins one line below the date. It should be left justified, no matter which format you are using.

Salutation

Use the same name as the inside address, including the personal title. If you know the person and typically address them by their first name, it is acceptable to use only the first name in the salutation (for example: Dear Lucy:). In all other cases, however, use the personal title and last/family name followed by a colon. Leave one line blank after the salutation.

If you don't know a reader's gender, use a nonsexist salutation, such as their job title followed by the receiver's name. It is also acceptable to use the full name in a salutation if you cannot determine gender. For example, you might write Dear Chris Harmon: if you were unsure of Chris's gender.

Body

For block and modified block formats, single space and left justify each paragraph within the body of the letter. Leave a blank line between each paragraph. When writing a business letter, be careful to remember that conciseness is very important. In the first paragraph, consider a friendly opening and then a statement of the main point. The next paragraph should begin justifying the importance of the main point. In the next few paragraphs, continue justification with background information and supporting details. The closing paragraph should restate the purpose of the letter and, in some cases, request some type of action.

Closing

The closing begins at the same vertical point as your date and one line after the last body paragraph. Capitalize the first word only (for example: Thank you) and leave four lines between the closing and the sender's name for a signature. If a colon follows the salutation, a comma should follow the closing; otherwise, there is no punctuation after the closing.

Enclosures

If you have enclosed any documents along with the letter, such as a resume, you indicate this simply by typing *Enclosures* below the closing. As an option, you may list the name of each document you are including in the envelope. For instance, if you have included many documents and need to ensure that the recipient is aware of each document, it may be a good idea to list the names.

\Typist initials

Typist initials are used to indicate the person who typed the letter. If you typed the letter yourself, omit the typist initials.

A Note About Format and Font

Block Format

When writing business letters, you must pay special attention to the format and font used. The most common layout of a business letter is known as block format. Using this format, the entire letter is left justified and single spaced except for a double space between paragraphs.

Modified Block

Another widely utilized format is known as modified block format. In this type, the body of the letter and the sender's and recipient's addresses are left justified and single-spaced. However, for the date and closing, tab to the center point and begin to type.

Semi-Block

The final, and least used, style is semi-block. It is much like the modified block style except that each paragraph is indented instead of left justified.

Keep in mind that different organizations have different format requirements for their professional communication. While the examples provided by the OWL contain common elements for the basic business letter (genre expectations), the format of your business letter may need to be flexible to reflect variables like letterheads and templates. Our examples are merely guides.

If your computer is equipped with Microsoft Office 2000, the Letter Wizard can be used to take much of the guesswork out of formatting business letters. To access the Letter Wizard, click on the Tools menu and then choose Letter Wizard. The Wizard will present the three styles mentioned here and input the date, sender address and recipient address into the selected format. Letter Wizard should only be used if you have a basic understand of how to write a business letter. Its templates are not applicable in every setting. Therefore, you should

consult a business writing handbook if you have any questions or doubt the accuracy of the Letter Wizard.

Font

Another important factor in the readability of a letter is the font. The generally accepted font is Times New Roman, size 12, although other fonts such as Arial may be used. When choosing a font, always consider your audience. If you are writing to a conservative company, you may want to use Times New Roman. However, if you are writing to a more liberal company, you have a little more freedom when choosing fonts.

Punctuation

Punctuation after the salutation and closing - use a colon (:) after the salutation (never a comma) and a comma (,) after the closing. In some circumstances, you may also use a less common format, known as open punctuation. For this style, punctuation is excluded after the salutation and the closing.

EXAMPLE OF A BUSINESS LETTER

Date

July 20, 20xx

Sender's Address

GP & Associates
2053 SW Channing Avenue, Suite 400
Denver, CO 80016

Inside Address

Ms Tia Turfingeon
ACTION ITEMS
3400 Onesite Parkway
Denver, CO 80016

Sub: _____

Salutation

Dear Ms. Turfingeon,

Body Text: I understand from our mutual acquaintance, Chad Johnson, that you are looking to retain an accountant to assist you in the sale of your business. I would welcome the opportunity to show you how GP & Associates was able to help Chad successfully sell his business earlier this year.

As you'll see on our website, my associates and I have extensive experience in financial accounting, internal audits, and tax compliance. For the past several years, we have specialized in business evaluation and transition services for sellers. We enjoy working closely with clients throughout the sale process to ensure a smooth transition. As our clients can attest, our various pre-sale price improvement strategies can significantly optimize a business's sale price.

Should you be thinking of purchasing another business, please note that we also offer business acquisition services. For your convenience, I have enclosed additional information describing GP & Associates full range of services.

Call to action: To set up an appointment to discuss your specific needs, please contact me at 303-449-0037. I know how busy you are, so I will give you a call on Tuesday to follow up if I haven't heard from you.

Best Regards,

Signature Block

Greg Parker

Enclosures

CC:_____

REPORT WRITING

Reports generally involve presenting your investigation and analysis of information or an issue, recommending actions and making proposals.

There are many different types of reports, including business, scientific and research reports, but the basic steps for writing them are the same. These are outlined below.

- Step 1: Decide on the 'Terms of reference'
- Step 2: Decide on the procedure
- Step 3: Find the information
- Step 4: Decide on the structure
- Step 5: Draft the first part of your report
- Step 6: Analyse your findings and draw conclusions
- Step 7: Make recommendations
- Step 8: Draft the executive summary and table of contents
- Step 9: Compile a reference list
- Step 10: Revise your draft report

You can also check our information on assignment writing for tips on planning, finding information, writing and reviewing your work.

Step-by-step guide to writing an assignment

Step 1: Decide on the 'Terms of reference'

To decide on the terms of reference for your report, read your instructions and any other information you've been given about the report, and think about the purpose of the report:

- What is it about?
- What exactly is needed?
- Why is it needed?
- When do I need to do it?
- Who is it for, or who is it aimed at?

This will help you draft your Terms of reference.

Step 2: Decide on the procedure

This means planning your investigation or research, and how you'll write the report. Ask yourself:

- What information do I need?
- Do I need to do any background reading?
- What articles or documents do I need?
- Do I need to contact the library for assistance?
- Do I need to interview or observe people?
- Do I have to record data?
- How will I go about this?

Answering these questions will help you draft the procedure section of your report, which outlines the steps you've taken to carry out the investigation.

Step 3: Find the information

The next step is to find the information you need for your report. To do this you may need to read written material, observe people or activities, and/or talk to people.

Make sure the information you find is relevant and appropriate. Check the assessment requirements and guidelines and the marking schedule to make sure you're on the right track. If you're not sure how the marks will be assigned contact your lecturer.

What you find out will form the basis, or main body, of your report – the findings.

For more on finding information:

Research and reading

Steps for writing an assignment

Step 4: Decide on the structure

Reports generally have a similar structure, but some details may differ. How they differ usually depends on:

- The type of report – if it is a research report, laboratory report, business report, investigative report, etc.
- How formal the report has to be.
- The length of the report.

Depending on the type of report, the structure can include:

- A title page.
- Executive summary.
- Contents.
- An introduction.
- Terms of reference.
- Procedure.
- Findings.
- Conclusions.
- Recommendations.
- References/Bibliography.
- Appendices.
- The sections, of a report usually have headings and subheadings, which are usually numbered

[The basic structure of a report](#) (PDF 262 KB; opens in a new window)

Step 5: Draft the first part of your report

Once you have your structure, write down the headings and start to fill these in with the information you have gathered so far. By now you should be able to draft the terms of reference, procedure and findings, and start to work out what will go in the report's appendix.

Findings

The findings are result of your reading, observations, interviews and investigation. They form the basis of your report. Depending on the type of report you are writing, you may also wish to include photos, tables or graphs to make your report more readable and/or easier to follow.

[Graphs - BBC Skillwise website](#) (opens in a new window)

Appendices

As you are writing your draft decide what information will go in the appendix. These are used for information that:

- is too long to include in the body of the report, or
- supplements or complements the information in the report. For example, brochures, spreadsheets or large tables.

Formatting and presenting your assignment

Step 6: Analyse your findings and draw conclusions

The conclusion is where you analyse your findings and interpret what you have found. To do this, read through your findings and ask yourself:

- What have I found?
- What's significant or important about my findings?
- What do my findings suggest?

For example, your conclusion may describe how the information you collected explains why the situation occurred, what this means for the organisation, and what will happen if the situation continues (or doesn't continue).

Don't include any new information in the conclusion.

Step 7: Make recommendations

Recommendations are what you think the solution to the problem is and/or what you think should happen next. To help you decide what to recommend:

- Reread your findings and conclusions.
- Think about what you want the person who asked for the report should to do or not do; what actions should they carry out?
- Check that your recommendations are practical and are based logically on your conclusions.
- Ensure you include enough detail for the reader to know what needs to be done and who should do it.

Your recommendations should be written as a numbered list, and ordered from most to least important.

Step 8: Draft the executive summary and table of contents

Some reports require an executive summary and/or list of contents. Even though these two sections come near the beginning of the report you won't be able to do them until you have finished it, and have your structure and recommendations finalised.

An executive summary is usually about 100 words long. It tells the readers what the report is about, and summarise the recommendations.

Step 9: Compile a reference list

This is a list of all the sources you've referred to in the report and uses APA referencing.

APA referencing

Step 10: Revise your draft report

It is always important to revise your work. Things you need to check include:

- If you have done what you were asked to do. Check the assignment question, the instructions/guidelines and the marking schedule to make sure.
 - That the required sections are included, and are in the correct order.
 - That your information is accurate, with no gaps.
 - If your argument is logical. Does the information you present support your conclusions and recommendations?
 - That all terms, symbols and abbreviations used have been explained.
 - That any diagrams, tables, graphs and illustrations are numbered and labelled.
 - That the formatting is correct, including your numbering, headings, are consistent throughout the report.
 - That the report reads well, and your writing is as clear and effective as possible.
-

TRANSLATION

English to Hind or Punjabi

1. Read the text
2. Underline the key words and difficult words
3. Know their meaning
4. Translate in your words in Hindi or Punjabi

